SHAME-06 | Therapist only - all age groups

A plan for when shame returns

1 | Purpose, fit and boundaries

Purpose of this unit

Summarize helpful responses and prepare a flexible response to situations where shame or criticism returns. The outcome is one choice, one boundary, and a way to receive support, without requiring the feeling to disappear.

Choice and adaptation

Choose this sheet following professional assessment and with consent. The person may skip questions, answer aloud, or choose another tool. This is proposed original material for review; it provides no score, diagnosis, or promise of an outcome.

Boundaries specific to this unit

Do not systematically search for mistakes, repeatedly check morality, or use the form to obtain forgiveness. This is not specialized trauma or OCD treatment. Increasing distress or impaired functioning requires appropriate assessment.

Reusing existing material

Choose only helpful elements from SHAME-02–05. Do not repeat the entire series whenever shame appears; SELF and REG are possible referrals according to need.

A fictional example for discussion

Fictional example: After new criticism, Shachar recognizes an old statement about himself. He uses a brief response and professional conversation without repeating every sheet or proving he is not to blame.

> Draft for administrator review. Clinical review and final rights approval are still pending.

Mindful Path

SHAME-06 | Therapist only - all age groups

Working together with the worksheet

2 | A conversation about one situation

Opening

Choose a situation the person wants to explore. It need not be the hardest situation. Check that the question is understood and the wording fits the person; their account comes before the therapist's interpretation.

1 | Question for discussion

What recurring contexts of shame matter for me to recognize?

2 | Question for discussion

What limited response suited me before?

3 | Question for discussion

What will help avoid repeated checking or repair?

4 | Question for discussion

What support is available when acting alone is difficult?

5 | Question for discussion

What changes in functioning need assessment beyond the plan?

Closing

Summarize what became clearer and what remains open. Use the existing SES-S01 and SES-S02 for the session framework. There is no need to repeat an assessment or plan already recorded.

Possible difficulties

If the plan becomes long, choose just one response and a route to help. When distress continues, do not add more tasks instead of assessing the need for suitable treatment.

Mindful Path

SHAME-06 | Therapist only - all age groups

Adapting for four age groups

3 | Age is a starting point, not an assumption about ability

CH | Children, approximately ages 6 to 11

An adult holds the support plan and does not make the child responsible for preventing feelings. A short phrase and a suitable adult's name can be enough, without identifying details on the sheet.

Offer one question at a time with little writing. Adult support must not replace the child's own voice.

TE | Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17

Preserve choice and privacy even when an adult is worried. Returning shame is not proof of failure or a reason to force disclosure.

Agree in advance what will be shared and with whom, and explain the privacy limits in this setting. Do not promise absolute confidentiality.

AD | Adults

Explore flexible use of the plan alongside work and relationships. If it becomes a checking ritual or self-punishment, reconsider its suitability.

OA | Older adults

Summarize in the participant's words and according to preferences. Do not assume they must settle past matters or reach forgiveness to finish the series.

Offer reading support, time, and conversation according to preference. Choose help from another person together with the participant, respecting their privacy.

> Each age version needs its own review. Approval of one version does not automatically approve the others.

Mindful Path

SHAME-06 | Therapist only - all age groups

Practice, review and next steps

4 | Shared choice and learning from the attempt

Before offering practice sheet P

Do not schedule daily repetition of the sheets. Use the plan as needed and by agreement; direct support-seeking may replace it.

At the next session

Check whether dignity, boundaries, and the ability to ask for support were preserved. Completing the series is not clinical approval or a promise that shame will not return.

Professional and technical records

Each version has a separate review record covering age suitability, originality, rights, and fictional filling. Reviewer and date fields remain blank until assigned. File checks or a code merge are not clinical approval. Clinical information stays only in the authorized setting, outside the code repository.

Background references

The following links were used for background only. Questions and adaptations were written afresh for the expansion plan; no questionnaire, scale, or protocol was copied. Adult sources do not validate the child versions. This material makes no claim about session count or treatment effectiveness.

www.nhs.uk/mental-health/self-help/tips-and-support/raise-low-self-esteem/
www.nhs.uk/every-mind-matters/lifes-challenges/maintaining-healthy-relationships-and-mental-wellbeing/

Mindful Path